

SAMPLE EMPLOYMENT AGREEMENT

Contract No. VTR-2026-00481

Effective Date: January 15, 2026

This Employment Agreement (the "Agreement") is entered into as of the 15th day of January 2026, by and between:

PARTY A (Employer): Meridian Technologies LLC, a company incorporated under the laws of the Dubai International Financial Centre (DIFC), with registration number CL-4892, having its principal office at Gate Village, Building 4, Level 3, DIFC, Dubai, United Arab Emirates (hereinafter referred to as the "Company");

AND

PARTY B (Employee): Dr. Alexandra Novakova, holder of passport number CZ-48291037, residing at 742 Evergreen Terrace, Apartment 12B, Jumeirah Beach Residence, Dubai, UAE (hereinafter referred to as the "Employee").

WHEREAS, the Company desires to employ the Employee in the capacity of Chief Legal Counsel, and the Employee desires to accept such employment, subject to the terms and conditions set forth herein;

WHEREAS, the Employee possesses specialized expertise in cross-border commercial litigation, regulatory compliance, and international arbitration;

NOW, THEREFORE, in consideration of the mutual covenants and agreements hereinafter set forth, and for other good and valuable consideration, the receipt and sufficiency of which are hereby acknowledged, the parties agree as follows:

ARTICLE I · POSITION AND DUTIES

Section 1.1. The Company hereby employs the Employee as Chief Legal Counsel, reporting directly to the Chief Executive Officer. The Employee shall perform all duties customarily associated with such position, including but not limited to: (a) overseeing all legal affairs of the Company; (b) managing external counsel relationships; (c) advising the Board of Directors on legal and regulatory matters; and (d) ensuring compliance with DIFC laws, UAE federal regulations, and applicable international standards.

Section 1.2. The Employee shall devote her full professional time, attention, and energies to the performance of her duties hereunder. The Employee shall not engage in any other business activity, whether or not such activity is pursued for gain, profit, or other pecuniary advantage, without the prior written consent of the Company.

Section 1.3. The Employee's primary place of work shall be the Company's offices at Gate Village, DIFC, Dubai. The Company may require reasonable business travel as necessary for the performance of the Employee's duties.

ARTICLE II · COMPENSATION AND BENEFITS

Section 2.1. Base Salary. The Company shall pay the Employee a base salary of AED 75,000 (Seventy-Five Thousand UAE Dirhams) per month, payable in accordance with the Company's standard payroll schedule, less applicable withholdings and deductions. The annual base salary equivalent is AED 900,000 (Nine Hundred Thousand UAE Dirhams), approximately USD 245,000.

Section 2.2. Annual Bonus. The Employee shall be eligible for an annual performance bonus of up to 30% of the base salary (maximum AED 270,000), based on the achievement of performance targets mutually agreed upon by the Employee and the CEO at the beginning of each fiscal year.

Section 2.3. Equity Participation. Subject to approval by the Board of Directors, the Employee shall be granted 15,000 restricted stock units (RSUs) under the Company's 2025 Equity Incentive Plan. Such RSUs shall vest over a four-year period, with 25% vesting on the first anniversary of the grant date and the remainder vesting monthly over the subsequent 36 months.

Section 2.4. Benefits. The Employee shall be entitled to: (a) comprehensive health insurance coverage for the Employee and her immediate family members (spouse and up to two dependent children); (b) annual leave of 30 working days per calendar year; (c) a housing allowance of AED 15,000 per month; (d) a transportation allowance of AED 5,000 per month; and (e) an annual education allowance of AED 50,000 for dependent children.

Section 2.5. Professional Development. The Company shall reimburse the Employee for reasonable expenses incurred in connection with continuing legal education, bar membership fees, and professional conference attendance, up to a maximum of AED 25,000 per calendar year.

ARTICLE III · TERM AND TERMINATION

Section 3.1. Initial Term. This Agreement shall commence on January 15, 2026 and shall continue for an initial term of three (3) years (the "Initial Term"), ending on January 14, 2029, unless earlier terminated in accordance with the provisions of this Article.

Section 3.2. Renewal. Upon expiration of the Initial Term, this Agreement shall automatically renew for successive one-year periods (each a "Renewal Term"), unless either party provides written notice of non-renewal at least ninety (90) days prior to the expiration of the then-current term.

Section 3.3. Termination by the Company Without Cause. The Company may terminate this Agreement at any time without cause upon providing the Employee with six (6) months' written notice or payment in lieu of notice equal to six months' base salary (AED 450,000).

Section 3.4. Termination for Cause. The Company may terminate this Agreement immediately for cause, including but not limited to: (a) material breach of this Agreement; (b) conviction of a criminal offense involving moral turpitude; (c) willful misconduct or gross negligence in the performance of duties; or (d) violation of the Company's Code of Ethics.

ARTICLE IV · CONFIDENTIALITY AND INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

Section 4.1. Confidential Information. The Employee acknowledges that during the course of employment, she will have access to and become acquainted with trade secrets, proprietary data, and other confidential information belonging to the Company (collectively, "Confidential Information"). Confidential Information includes, without limitation: client lists, fee structures, litigation strategies, business plans, financial projections, software algorithms, and any information designated as confidential by the Company.

Section 4.2. Non-Disclosure Obligation. The Employee shall not, during the term of employment or at any time thereafter, directly or indirectly, disclose, publish, or otherwise reveal any Confidential Information to any third party, except as required in the proper performance of her duties or as authorized in writing by the Company.

Section 4.3. Return of Materials. Upon termination of employment for any reason, the Employee shall immediately return to the Company all documents, electronic files, and other materials containing or relating to Confidential Information.

Section 4.4. Intellectual Property Assignment. All inventions, discoveries, improvements, and works of authorship conceived or created by the Employee during the course of employment and related to the Company's business shall be the sole and exclusive property of the Company. The Employee hereby assigns all rights, title, and interest in such intellectual property to the Company.

ARTICLE V · NON-COMPETITION AND NON-SOLICITATION

Section 5.1. Non-Competition. During the term of employment and for a period of twelve (12) months following termination (the "Restricted Period"), the Employee shall not, directly or indirectly, engage in, be employed by, consult for, or have any ownership interest in any business that competes with the Company within the DIFC, the UAE, or any jurisdiction in which the Company conducts business as of the termination date.

Section 5.2. Non-Solicitation of Clients. During the Restricted Period, the Employee shall not, directly or indirectly, solicit or attempt to solicit any client or prospective client of the Company with whom the Employee had material contact during the last twenty-four (24) months of employment.

Section 5.3. Non-Solicitation of Employees. During the Restricted Period, the Employee shall not, directly or indirectly, recruit, solicit, or encourage any employee or contractor of the Company to leave the Company's employ or to terminate their engagement with the Company.

Section 5.4. Consideration for Restrictions. In consideration of the non-competition and non-solicitation obligations set forth in this Article, the Company shall pay the Employee a monthly garden leave payment of AED 37,500 (50% of base salary) during the Restricted Period, provided the Employee complies with all obligations under this Article.

ARTICLE VI · DISPUTE RESOLUTION

Section 6.1. Governing Law. This Agreement shall be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of the Dubai International Financial Centre, as supplemented by the laws of England and Wales to the extent applicable under DIFC Law.

Section 6.2. Arbitration. Any dispute, controversy, or claim arising out of or relating to this Agreement, or the breach, termination, or invalidity thereof, shall be settled by arbitration administered by the DIFC-LCIA Arbitration Centre in accordance with the DIFC-LCIA Arbitration Rules in force at the time of the commencement of the arbitration. The tribunal shall consist of a sole arbitrator. The seat of arbitration shall be the DIFC, Dubai. The language of the arbitration shall be English.

Section 6.3. Injunctive Relief. Notwithstanding the foregoing, either party may seek injunctive or other equitable relief from the DIFC Courts to prevent any actual or threatened breach of the confidentiality, non-competition, or non-solicitation provisions of this Agreement.

ARTICLE VII · GENERAL PROVISIONS

Section 7.1. Entire Agreement. This Agreement constitutes the entire agreement between the parties with respect to the subject matter hereof and supersedes all prior negotiations, representations, warranties, commitments, offers, and agreements, whether written or oral.

Section 7.2. Amendments. No modification, amendment, or waiver of any provision of this Agreement shall be effective unless in writing and signed by both parties.

Section 7.3. Severability. If any provision of this Agreement is held to be invalid or unenforceable, the remaining provisions shall continue in full force and effect.

Section 7.4. Notices. All notices required or permitted under this Agreement shall be in writing and shall be delivered personally, sent by registered mail, or transmitted by email to the addresses set forth above, or to such other address as either party may designate by written notice.

Section 7.5. Counterparts. This Agreement may be executed in counterparts, each of which shall be deemed an original, and all of which together shall constitute one and the same instrument.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, the parties hereto have executed this Agreement as of the date first written above.

For: Meridian Technologies LLC Dr. Alexandra Novakova

Name: James Richardson Employee

Title: Chief Executive Officer

Date: January 15, 2026 Date: January 15, 2026

Witness: Sarah Al-Mahmoud, Notary Public, DIFC Courts